

Best Times & Frequency to Post on Social Media

2026 Edition — Data-backed peak engagement windows and posting cadence for every major platform,
compiled from Sprout Social, Buffer, and Hootsuite research. Updated July 2026.

The Big Picture

Across nearly **2 billion engagements** on 307,000 profiles, Sprout Social's 2026 study found engagement peaks **midday to late afternoon (11 a.m.–6 p.m.)**, with **Tuesdays and Wednesdays** the strongest days on almost every platform. **Sunday is the worst day** to post across the board. Published timing studies estimate posting at peak times lifts engagement by roughly **20–30%** versus posting at random times.

At a Glance — All Platforms

Platform	Best Times (local time)	Best Days	Avoid
Facebook	Mon 12–1 p.m. · Tue–Wed 12–8 p.m. · Thu 12–2 p.m.	Tue, Wed	Sunday, early mornings
Instagram	Mon 2–4 p.m. · Tue 1–7 p.m. · Wed 12–9 p.m. · Thu 12–2 p.m.	Tue, Wed	Weekends
TikTok	Tue–Thu 2–6 p.m. (Sprout) · Sun 9 a.m., Mon 1 p.m., Fri evenings (Buffer)	Tue–Thu; Sat strong for video	Very early a.m.
LinkedIn	Tue & Thu 1–5 p.m. (Sprout) · weekdays 3–8 p.m. (Buffer)	Tue, Thu	Weekends
X (Twitter)	Tue–Thu 12–6 p.m.	Tue, Wed, Thu	Sunday
YouTube	Thu & Fri afternoons · Sunday for long-form uploads	Thu, Fri, Sun	Mon–Tue mornings
Pinterest	Tue–Thu 10 a.m.–1 p.m. (Sprout) · evenings 8–11 p.m. also strong (RecurPost)	Tue–Thu; weekend evenings	Overnight
Threads	Sun 11 a.m. top slot · early mornings 6–7 a.m. also perform	Wednesday	Late nights

All times are your **audience's local time zone**. Where major studies disagree, both findings are shown — platform-level detail and study methodology are on the following pages.

How Often to Post — Recommended Frequency

Frequency benchmarks from Buffer's 2026 frequency guide, HeyOrca, and Social Champ. The overriding 2026 finding: **quality beats quantity**. Buffer's study of 1.2 million posts found accounts posting 2–3×/week with high engagement grew **2.4× faster** than accounts posting daily with low engagement.

Platform	Recommended Frequency	Notes
Facebook	1–2 posts per day	One strong daily post is usually enough to stay visible.
Instagram	3–5 feed posts/week + daily Stories + 2–3 Reels/week	Reels and Stories carry reach; feed anchors the profile.
TikTok	2–5 posts/week; up to 1–3/day for aggressive growth	Daily posters see ~3.5× faster follower growth than 2–3×/week posters. Volume is rewarded more than on any other platform.
LinkedIn	2–5 posts/week (2–3 is the sweet spot)	Consistent 2–3/week over six months correlates with ~78% higher follower growth than irregular bursts. Posts have a long shelf life.
X (Twitter)	2–5 posts per day	Short post lifespan (hours); higher frequency has the least downside here.
YouTube	1 long-form video/week + 3–7 Shorts/week	Consistency beats frequency — a reliable weekly slot outperforms sporadic uploads.
Pinterest	15–25 pins per day (top performers)	Pinning 50+/day can hurt distribution; spread pins across the day.
Threads	1–2 posts per day	Conversational cadence; consistency matters more than volume.

Platform-by-Platform Detail

Facebook

Engagement concentrates in the afternoon and holds momentum into the evening. Sprout Social's 2026 global peak: **Monday 12–1 p.m., Tuesday–Wednesday 12–8 p.m., Thursday 12–2 p.m.**, with Wednesday 10 a.m. the strongest single slot. Hootsuite (data from 300 B2B/B2C brands) also supports Monday–Wednesday, 9 a.m.–12 p.m., and finds engagement rates run 18% higher on Thursdays/Fridays and 32% higher on weekends for some audiences — worth testing. Avoid early-morning posts.

Instagram

Midweek afternoons drive the most consistent engagement: **Monday 2–4 p.m., Tuesday 1–7 p.m., Wednesday 12–9 p.m., Thursday 12–2 p.m.** (Sprout Social). Buffer's analysis of 9.6M posts points to **Thursday 9 a.m.** and **Wednesday 12 p.m. and 6 p.m.** as top slots; Hootsuite's single best hour is Wednesday 11 a.m. Retail brands do best weekdays 12–3 p.m. (lunch-break browsing). Weekends yield the lowest engagement across almost all industries.

TikTok

Sprout Social's peak window is **Tuesday–Thursday 2–6 p.m.** Buffer's study of 7.1M posts found **Saturday** is the best-performing day overall (then Monday and Sunday), with strong slots at Sunday 9 a.m., Monday 1 p.m., and Friday evenings. Key tactic: **post 30–60 minutes before** a peak window opens — TikTok needs lead time to begin distributing your video before the audience surge arrives.

LinkedIn

A late-day productivity and networking hub: **Tuesday and Thursday, 1–5 p.m.** (Sprout Social). Buffer's 4.8M-post analysis shows 2026 peak windows shifting later than prior years, with **3–8 p.m. on weekdays** pulling some of the strongest engagement. Skip weekends.

X (Twitter)

Best window: **Tuesday–Thursday, 12–6 p.m.** (Sprout Social). Midweek midday-to-afternoon aligns with news and commentary consumption habits; Sunday is weakest.

YouTube

Thursday and Friday afternoons perform best for standard uploads, and **Sunday** is the strongest upload day for long-form content — viewers binge on weekends, and YouTube's recommendation system benefits from pre-weekend publishing. Weekend performance is notably strong for video platforms generally.

Pinterest

Sprout Social: **Tuesday–Thursday, 10 a.m.–1 p.m.** — pinners plan and seek inspiration during midday lulls. RecurPost's 2M+-pin study emphasizes **evenings (8–11 p.m.)**, especially Friday–Sunday. Evenings are strong all seven days; test both windows for your audience.

Threads

Buffer's 2.5M-post analysis: **Wednesday** is the best day by overall engagement, and **Sunday 11 a.m.** is the single best slot, with 6–7 a.m. also performing well.

How to Use These Times

- **Schedule in your audience's time zone**, not your own. If your followers span regions, weight toward your largest audience cluster.
- **Treat these as starting points.** Every study stresses that your own analytics (Instagram Insights, TikTok Analytics, YouTube Studio, etc.) beat any generic chart — run 2–4 weeks of tests against these windows and keep what wins.
- **Consistency compounds.** Regular cadence at good times outperforms sporadic posting at perfect times.
- **For video (TikTok/Reels/Shorts), publish 30–60 minutes before the peak** so the algorithm has distribution lead time.
- **Avoid Sundays** for most platforms — the lowest-engagement day across Sprout Social's dataset — except TikTok, Threads, and long-form YouTube, where weekends can outperform.

Methodology of the Underlying Studies

Sprout Social (2026): ~2 billion engagements across ~307,000 social profiles on Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Pinterest, TikTok and X, from 30,000+ customers globally, collected November 27, 2025 – February 27, 2026. **Buffer (2026):** platform-specific analyses of 9.6M Instagram posts, 7.1M TikTok posts, 4.8M LinkedIn posts, and 2.5M Threads posts. **Hootsuite (2026):** engagement data from 300 B2B and B2C brand accounts. **RecurPost (2026):** 2M+ Pinterest pins. **Frequency benchmarks:** Buffer's 2026 frequency guide (including a 1.2M-post growth study), with corroborating platform cadence data from HeyOrca and Social Champ.

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Compiled July 24, 2026. Times reflect aggregate study data; individual audience behavior varies — validate against your own account analytics.